

Q+A

HIGH ON INDIA

Musician **Sting**, a true-blue Indophile, is looking forward to performing at Lollapalooza India in Mumbai later this month

Q. Are you excited to perform in India again?

My first visit to India was also for a performance—back in 1980, with The Police. And it was the best performance of my life.... I remember asking the audience to dance, and all the old ladies in their saris got up on their seats with their umbrellas. The Lollapalooza line-up is an experience of a lifetime! I'm not sure if the audience there has seen me before, so I'll be judging it number by number. But I do hope everybody will be up and dancing.

Q. India features in your travel plans almost annually. What keeps drawing you here?

Trudie and I have been fascinated by all things Indian—from Hinduism and sitar music to yoga and more! I've been coming here for more than three decades, to celebrate New Year in Goa, to camp in the Thar desert, sometimes to join pilgrims visiting the Yamuna and Ganges rivers. I have driven a bike across Rajasthan—and that inspired 'Desert Rose'.

Q. You recently launched a spirit...

When I co-developed Amante 1530, it was not just an amaro for me. I wanted it to reflect who I am. Food, and drink, like music, is also very personal art. So through Amante, I wanted to send a message of connection, reverence, joy, and what better way of sending a message than in a bottle!

Q. Are you exploring collaborations with musicians in India?

I'm definitely open to the idea. Ravi Shankar and Anoushka helped me understand a lot about Indian music. I want to meet A.R. Rahman, and a few independent musicians to broaden my perspective on Indian music. It would be really nice if and when something can happen.

with Aarti Kapur Singh

GETTY IMAGES